

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Microsoft Sentinel and Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) | Detection Engineering | Kusto Query Language (KQL)

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of hands-on experience investigating, triaging and responding to cyber security incidents across complex Microsoft environments. In my current role I run detection engineering, threat hunting and Security Operations across Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) and Azure security technologies for an estate of more than 8,000 users. I have advanced Kusto Query Language (KQL) skills for investigations, detections and reporting, and I build automated response workflows using Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks and Logic Apps style workflow patterns. I drive vulnerability management across cloud, network and infrastructure environments and I contribute continuously to the ongoing development of security processes, controls and incident response capability. I am now looking to bring this experience to a senior lead role at a growing international organisation in Central London on a hybrid basis.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel:** Analytics rules, workbooks, hunting queries, watchlists, User and Entity Behaviour Analytics (UEBA), data connectors and log ingestion tuning
- **Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for Office 365 and Defender for Cloud Apps; 8,000 user enterprise deployment
- **Azure Security Technologies:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Azure logging and Log Analytics
- **Kusto Query Language (KQL):** Advanced queries for detection engineering, incident investigation, threat hunting and executive reporting
- **Detection Engineering and Threat Detection:** Custom analytics rules, use case development, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, alert tuning and false positive reduction
- **Security Automation:** SOAR playbooks, Logic Apps style workflow orchestration, PowerShell scripting for enrichment and containment
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Next Generation SIEM, Prevent, Insight, Discover
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; remediation across cloud, network and infrastructure
- **Incident Response:** National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61 lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK, forensic triage, containment, recovery and lessons learned
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust; secrets vaulting, session monitoring, least privilege
- **Additional Tooling:** Mimecast, Tanium, Check Point Harmony, Intune (Mobile Device Management / Mobile Application Management), Splunk / Search Processing Language (SPL)
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), Center for Internet Security (CIS) Controls, International Organization for Standardization (ISO) 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Investigate, triage and respond to cyber security incidents across a complex Microsoft environment covering more than 8,000 users, cloud workloads and hybrid infrastructure.
- Monitor and manage security events using Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR); own the analytics rule set, workbooks and hunting notebooks.

- Author advanced Kusto Query Language (KQL) queries for detection engineering, investigation, threat hunting and executive reporting.
- Drive vulnerability management and remediation across cloud, network and infrastructure environments using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation, Tenable.io and AppCheck.
- Build detection engineering, threat detection and security automation workflows using Logic Apps style playbooks and SOAR orchestration, reducing analyst effort on repeatable incident types.
- Contribute to the ongoing development of security processes, controls and incident response capability aligned to NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK.
- Manage identity security in Azure Active Directory / Entra ID including Conditional Access, MFA, Single Sign-On and Privileged Identity Management.
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Mimecast email security and BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management alongside the Microsoft security stack.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Delivered the enterprise deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI) to more than 8,000 users, defining baseline configuration, response actions and reporting.
- Onboarded data sources into Microsoft Sentinel and built the initial analytics rule library, workbooks and playbooks for the Security Operations function.
- Investigated and responded to cyber security incidents in an enterprise environment, following NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK.
- Wrote advanced KQL queries for detection tuning, incident timelines and reporting to senior stakeholders.
- Ran vulnerability management operations across cloud and on premise assets, prioritising remediation using Common Vulnerability Scoring System (CVSS) and business risk.
- Configured Azure Active Directory / Entra ID Conditional Access, MFA and Single Sign-On patterns to enforce zero trust identity controls.
- Supported delivery of Cyber Essentials Plus and internal ISO 27001 aligned control assessments.

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Supported Security Operations for a Software as a Service platform serving global enterprise customers.
- Ran vulnerability scanning, patching and endpoint hardening across cloud and on premise systems.
- Supported Microsoft 365 and Azure security baselines and assisted with incident triage across identity, endpoint and email tooling.
- Coordinated remediation of security tickets alongside Development Operations (DevOps) and engineering teams.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Delivered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI) rollout across an 8,000 user enterprise, giving Security Operations end to end telemetry for incident investigation.
- Built the Microsoft Sentinel analytics rule library and hunting notebooks used daily for detection engineering and threat hunting, backed by advanced Kusto Query Language (KQL).
- Automated repeatable incident response actions using SOAR playbook and Logic Apps style patterns, cutting analyst toil on high volume alerts.
- Reduced exploitable exposure through consistent vulnerability management using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation, Tenable.io and AppCheck.
- Standardised Conditional Access, MFA and privileged access controls, hardening the identity plane against modern attacker tradecraft.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)

- CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
-

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)